

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in case management, court preparation and client-facing advice across disputes and public-facing legal work. At BCLP, prepared electronic hearing bundles, managed case files and tracked procedural deadlines on a range of contentious matters. At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, advises clients in vulnerable circumstances on housing, family, welfare benefits and debt matters, managing files from instruction to submission and communicating complex procedural requirements clearly. Experienced in electronic case management systems, document review and electronic court filing. Particular interest in public-facing legal work where procedural rigour and client impact intersect.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Interviews clients across family, housing, welfare benefits, employment, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points
- Advises clients in vulnerable circumstances on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court filings, skeleton arguments and other court materials
- Maintained matter records on iManage; managed deadline tracking and matter opening and closure
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial on a complex investment arbitration
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Became sole junior supporting the team before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with client on required documents
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified legal and compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, client-focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed data-processing and confidentiality provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; document review; electronic bundling; electronic court filing portals; iManage; case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, electronic hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking, client-facing file management from instruction to submission